Literary Museums as Part of Tradition Mediation





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Literature - in isolation - individual - armchairs and own imagination











Literature - commons - tangible - spectaular - public space

Spoken Word





Poetry Slam











The ongoing growth of literary museums

- some paper conclusions

- the cultural heritage field's most ready concretization of literature
- the literary history field's most user-friendly strategy
- the museum field's most clear answer to a changing situations of language

These museums will attend to a greater part of the tradition mediation

Literary tradition and heritage infrastructure - ways and forms of maintaining

- 1. Re-publishing/re-editing/new translations
  ongoing intrinsic language cultivating - and book market availability
- 2. Critic and scholar treatises/accounts/stories
  many formats and levels, education, printed and digital
- 3. Remediating
  screen and audio versions, adaptations, cartoons, computer games etc.
- 4. Space-defined/-oriented performing
  theatre, scenes of reading and new orality etc. - temporary
- 5. Relics cultivating
  museums, archives, memorials etc. - permanent

Why literary museum is interesting challenges - contradictions - and so inquieries?

- A spiritual, aesthetic, immaterial phaenomenon
  - to be musealized - physical-material, visual

- A mass-printed, mass copied media without place
  - to be made museum artefact - unique, specific

- The digtital, fluctating text/literary culture
  - to be balanced by place, space, simplicity

Why is literary museums' growth interesting

- print culture and literary tradition have lost much of its former self-evidence, authority, hierarchical order and cultural prerogative

- the long-lived communication patterns have been challenged by visual media, new orality, digital forms, other literacies etc.

At the same time in 2000es
changing/disappearing - musealization

- Literature going digital - books disappear
  production - distribution - mediation - consumption

- Literature going pyhisical - into museums
  exhibition artefacts, visual objects in a room

Which connection?

Some simple explanations/causalities …

1. As and when language and literature go digital,

   The physical museums of literature with
   space, place, visuality and tangible, non-digital material will build up

2. As and when globalization, migration, mobility, time-space separation, velocity, risks etc. increase,

   The need for stability, roots, tradition, community and identity will increase – and national language/literature/classics can fulfill this

For both: <u>reduction of complexity</u>

The MLA-situation ?

- The official library/archive system takes care of the society's texts, literature, books, records

- so, special literary museums are 'not neccesary'
  - they are to be optional/surplus whipped cream

- Or can museums take the literature?

Types and terms - a scale …

- Book museum
- Author museum
- Literary historical/biographical museum (ICLM)
- Literary museum
- Museum of literature
- Literary memorial
- Literary visiting place

- The same as a library or archive
- Museum as a collection of texts

- And now many picture slides as for the types

Book museums









Author museums

Skien, Grimstad, Oslo Henrik Ibsen











Author museum and home
Jenle, Denmark, Jeppe Aakjær







Author museum and home
Rungstedlund, Denmark, Karen Blixen









Author home and museum

Mårbacka, Sweden

Selma Lagerlöf

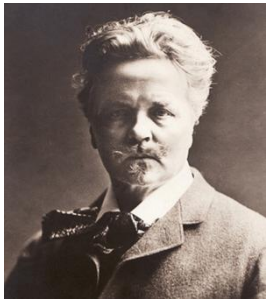






Preserved and staged by the author herself about 1920

Author museum
Strindberg museum (Blå tornet), Stockholm



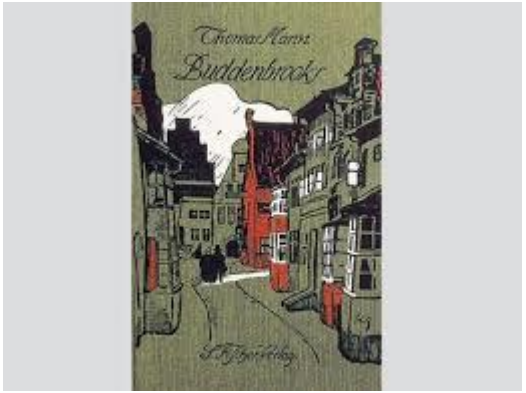




Literary museum Buddenbrookhaus Lübeck





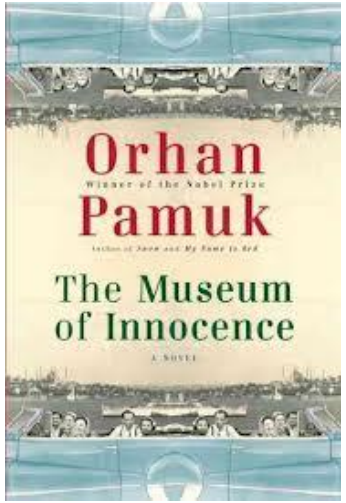






Literary museum
Museum of Innocence
Istanbul











Literary Museum
H C Andersen house
Odense, Denmark







and presumed birth-house

Literary museum

Literaturmuseum der Moderne
Marbach, Germany









Literary museum - reenactment land

Astrid Lindgren Värld,
Vimmerby, Sweden





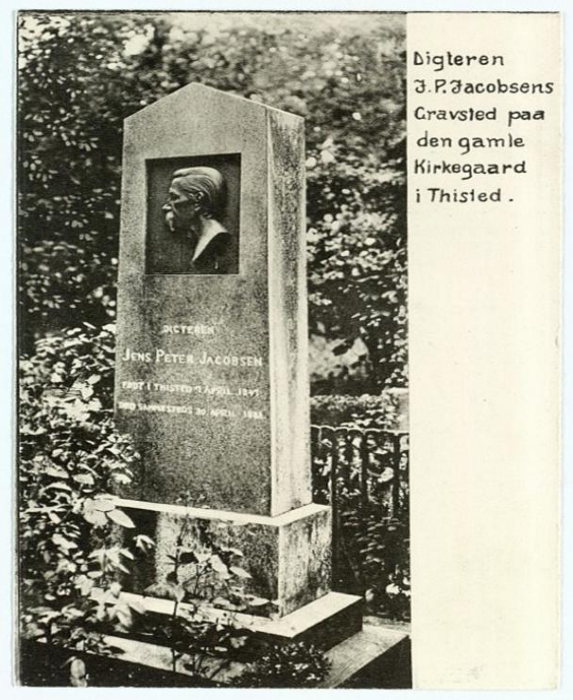








Literary memorials









Memorial - light musealization

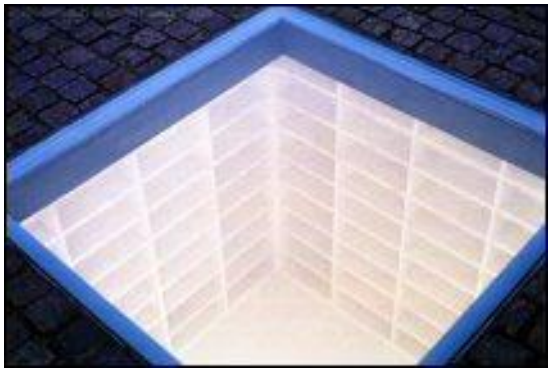
Bebels Platz, Berlin
- tangible and intangible
book cultural heritage



1933 book burning



1995



Urban representations - fame confirmation
ligth musealization

Dublin



Madrid



Literary tours – visiting places

Jane Austen's Hampshire

Explore the county of England where Jane Austen spent most of her life.
Visiting sites where she lived, worked and was inspired by
plus a few places used as setting for recent films of her works!



Jane's table

Literary museums – mostly author museums - charateristics/varieties

- Mostly small places
- Decentered, according to place, home, birth …
  (single artist museums)
- Private ownership (partnerships)
- Society/friend circle/foundation-connected
- Coincide with memorial
- Not much research
- Small economy - little state subsidy
- Some very tourist popular

The vigorous author – the larger part of literary museums

- Popular view - the author is the most important part for a text

- A face in an anonymous society
- An island in publishing-overloaded ocean
- Local rooting - ‘from here he came …’

- Classic humanistic view of personality
- A life story to be seen (sometimes better than the texts …)

- Genesis myth, inspiration, origin source, intentionality - aura
- The visible craft - authenticity

- Now something about Methodology and angels

Raisons d’être for literary museum/author museum

- to counterbalance the anonymity of the mass-printed books via nearness, unique specimens and typically handwritten things left behind

- to get the sublime, immaterial and aesthetic literary texts down to earth by attaching them to a concrete place and an ordinary world (home, bed, typewriter etc.)

- to bring out an aura of both these sides

The museum guests at a literary museum

- They fundamentally and dedicatedly bear a large invisible ballast of reading and a beloved mental imagination universe - neither very material

- The museums have to cope with, install and visualize this;
  every simple component: letters, imaginations, silence,
  feelings, voices etc. must be given a sort of material form to
  fascinate in the museum room (– or/and the digital room?)

Relevant current tendencies within literary studies

- The new book history - artefact – text – context
- Theories of presence - space, place and specific moment
- Theories of performance - scenes, interaction, visuality, body, literature have moved out of the book
- Paratext - circulation's texts
  the literary museum itself is a paratext
- Literary geography - theories of place
- Biography authorship and archives' material revealing

methodology guidelines for vitalizing literary museums - some proposals

- Securing scholarly and aesthetic literary qualifications/professionals within the institutions
- distinguishing between author and text, focusing the impact and context of the latter
- accepting author person as popular and unavoidable - thereafter deconstruct it
- focusing the non-author related components of literature and demystifying the genesis of literature

Guidelines … continued

- accepting the wealth of available records - but not let them raise the issues
- acknowledging national identity attached to language - thereafter deconstruct it
- bringing out the modern book history paradigm with the concept of transmission
- looking after that literature is easily movable as an object
- focusing the performance potentialities and the many scenes of literary texts

Under today's digital conditions … obvious questions

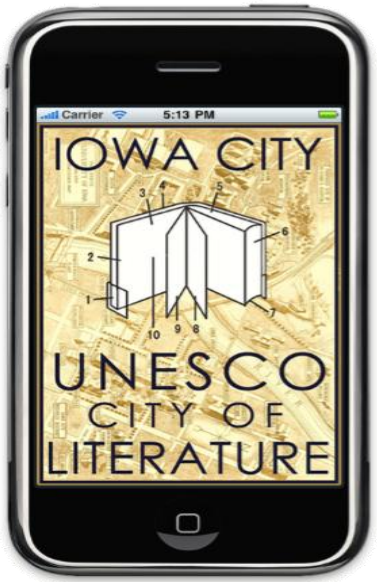
- Is the most interesting and fascinating of the literary museums' content the non-digital material?

- how can and must non-material digital mediations/representations/texts operate?

Do the e-book and the digital space ’cause’ the new social sharing and physical presence of literary life and experience ?





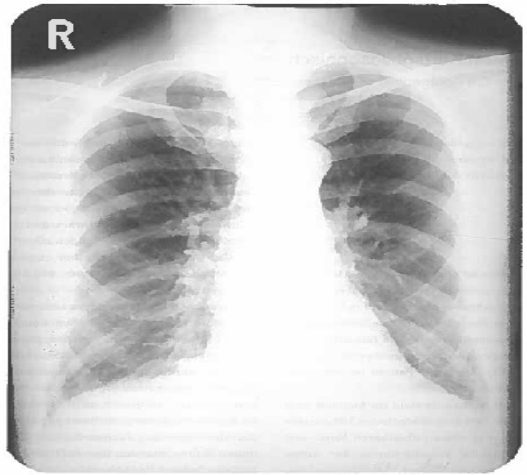


Of great interest?

manuscripts
Heidegger 1927



X-ray picture
Karl Jaspers 1952



Media development

Mediated

- Dvd
- Book a.o. printing
- www-picture
- Cd
- Radio/tv

- Non og less fixed to space and place and time
- Individual and autonomous

Unmediated

- Theatre performance
- Reading
- Physical object
- Live-concert
- Memorial place

- Fixed to space and place – and time

- Typically collective

Thank you!



Gumbrechts teori om tilgang til verden

betydningskultur

- Det mentale prioriteres
- Fortolkning/Betydning
- Det materielle er en kilde til at 'se bagom' og til at se den store kontekst

- Tanke
- Kronologi/forløb

- 'fremkaldt' viden
- Tid i lang kronologi

tilstedeværelseskultur

- Det materielle prioriteres
- Tilstedevær/nærvær
- Det materielle har selvstændig substans og sanselig tilgængelighed

- Krop
- Samtidighed

- 'utilsløret' viden

Hvorfor er oplevelse kommet ‘mere på dagordenen’?



Fokus på læseren og receptionen
(stemning, sansning, nydelse, krop, erindring …)

Læserne optræder i flok/kollektiv reception (scener og krop)

Bedre muligheder for at installere litteratur i
Rumlige sammenhænge (scener, litt.rejser …)

Mere tværæstetik/multisanselighed – lyd/musik/billede

Oplevelsessamfund/-økonomi (der er penge og øget attraktion i at producere oplevelser…)
Det gør oplevelsesdesignet